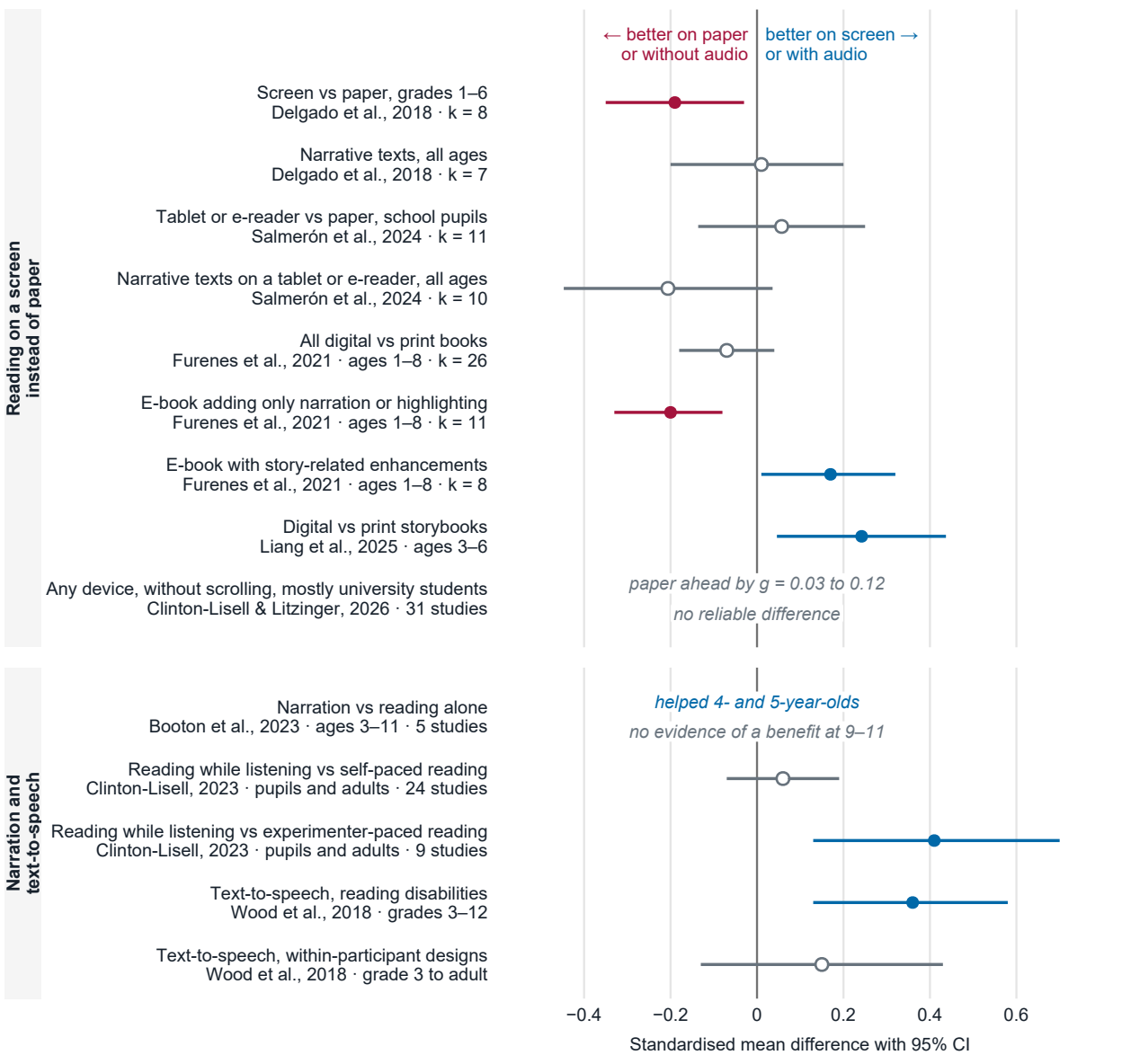

Reading on a screen instead of paper
Narration and text-to-speech
← better on paper or without audio
better on screen → or with audio
Screen vs paper, grades 1–6
Delgado et al., 2018 · k = 8
Narrative texts, all ages
Delgado et al., 2018 · k = 7
Tablet or e-reader vs paper, school pupils
Salmerón et al., 2024 · k = 11
Narrative texts on a tablet or e-reader, all ages
Salmerón et al., 2024 · k = 10
All digital vs print books
Furenes et al., 2021 · ages 1–8 · k = 26
E-book adding only narration or highlighting
Furenes et al., 2021 · ages 1–8 · k = 11
E-book with story-related enhancements
Furenes et al., 2021 · ages 1–8 · k = 8
Digital vs print storybooks
Liang et al., 2025 · ages 3–6
Any device, without scrolling, mostly university students
Clinton-Lisell & Litzinger, 2026 · 31 studies
paper ahead by g = 0.03 to 0.12
no reliable difference
Narration vs reading alone
Booton et al., 2023 · ages 3–11 · 5 studies
Reading while listening vs self-paced reading
Clinton-Lisell, 2023 · pupils and adults · 24 studies
Reading while listening vs experimenter-paced reading
Clinton-Lisell, 2023 · pupils and adults · 9 studies
Text-to-speech, reading disabilities
Wood et al., 2018 · grades 3–12
Text-to-speech, within-participant designs
Wood et al., 2018 · grade 3 to adult
helped 4- and 5-year-olds
no evidence of a benefit at 9–11
−0.4
−0.2
0
0.2
0.4
0.6
Standardised mean difference with 95% CI